

Emiliano Calvo Alcañiz

<https://github.com/emilianocal>
ecalvoal@arizona.edu

Education

2023-Present	PhD in Entomology & Insect Science Graduate Interdisciplinary Program. University of Arizona, Tucson.
2019-2022	Bachelor of Science in Environmental Science and Policy - Concentration in Wildlife Ecology and Management. University of Maryland, College Park.
2021-2023	Minor in Entomology. University of Maryland, College Park.

Areas of Interest

Contest behavior, Social insects, Animal behavior, Ecology, Conservation

Research Experience

2023-Present	Graduate research assistant with Anna Dornhaus studying contest behavior of <i>Temnothorax rugatulus</i> . University of Arizona, Tucson.
2022–2023	Research assistant in Espíndola Lab studying ecology of serpentine grasslands pollinators and parasitoid diversity in agroecosystems. University of Maryland, College Park.
2022–2023	Research assistant in Mullinax Lab studying spatial ecology of <i>Ixodes scapularis</i> (Black-legged ticks). University of Maryland, College Park.
2021–2022	Research technician in Mullinax Lab studying ecology of <i>Canis latrans</i> (Coyotes) in Washington, DC. University of Maryland, College Park.

Peer-Reviewed Publications

Calvo Alcañiz, E., Chism, G. T., Rathery, A., Dornhaus, A. (IN PREP). Nest shape does not affect ant colony performance against a nest invader despite altered worker movement and communication.

Research Presentations

2026	International Union for the Study of Social Insects International meeting
2024	Research Showcase, University of Arizona Graduate Interdisciplinary Program
2024	Entomology Society of America, National Meeting

2024 International Union for the Study of Social Insects, North American Meeting

Teaching Experience

2026 Graduate Teaching Assistant for **ECOL 302**, University of Arizona, Tucson.
Duties include: Leading 2 lab sections of ~22 students (45 total)

2026 Graduate Teaching Assistant for **ECOL 182L**, University of Arizona, Tucson.
Duties include: Leading 2 lab sections of ~25 students (50 total)

2025 Graduate Teaching Assistant for **ECOL 302**, University of Arizona, Tucson.
Duties include: Leading 2 lab sections of ~22 students (45 total)

2025 Graduate Teaching Assistant for **ECOL 182L**, University of Arizona, Tucson.
Duties include: Leading 2 lab sections of ~25 students (50 total)

2024 Graduate Teaching Assistant for **ENTO 160D**, University of Arizona, Tucson.
Duties included: Leading lecture for 80 students, grading 200 assignments/week.

Mentorship

2026 Keep Engaging Youth in Science (KEYS) Research mentor to 2 high school students

2024-2025 Students Taking Advantage of Research (STAR) Lab mentor to 1 high school student

2024-Present Mentor to 3 undergraduate students

Outreach and Extension

2026 Insect Discovery, University of Arizona, Tucson

2025-Present Sky School Instructor

2024 Vesey Elementary School career day speaker

2023, 2025 Rabies/tick-borne disease clinic in the Tohono O'odham nation.

2023 Cricket behavior project at Carillo K-5 Elementary School

2023, 2024 Insect Festival, University of Arizona, Tucson.

2022-2023 United States Forest Service, working with Karin Theophile on urban outreach in communities that are underrepresented in STEM.

2022, 2023 Maryland Day, Insect Zoo event staff, University of Maryland, College Park.

2022-2023 Insect Zoo educator, University of Maryland, College Park.

Service

2026	President of the University of Arizona Student Entomological Association
2023, 2024, 2026	Student liaison for Graduate Interdisciplinary Program in Entomology & Insect Science
2024-Present	Lead peer counselor with the University of Arizona Counseling & Psych Services (CAPS)
2024	Peer mentor with University of Arizona Grad CAFE Pilot program
2022–2023	Communications Chair of Delta Alpha Pi Gamma Rho Honor Society.
2022–2023	Member of the Entomological Student Organization, University of Maryland, College Park.
2019–2023	Vice President of Political Latinxs United for Movement and Action in Society (PLUMAS), University of Maryland, College Park.
2020	Member of University-wide Hiring Committee for the Undocumented Student Program Coordinator position, appointed by Vice President of Student Affairs at the University of Maryland, College Park.
2020	Chair of Public Relations in the Coalition of Latinx Student Organizations (CLSO), University of Maryland, College Park.
2019–2020	Member of the Student Sustainability Committee, University of Maryland, College Park.

Non-Academic Work Experience

2020–2022	Legislative Aide for Prince George’s County Council, Upper Marlboro, Maryland.
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Certifications

2026	Mental Health First Aid Certificate
2024	Psychological First Aid (PFA) certification

Awards and Honors

2026	Herbert Carter Travel Award (\$600)
2026	Jack Root Graduate Fellowship for Urban Entomology (\$1092.00)
2025	Howard Bendalin Agricultural Student Support Scholarship (\$1010.00)
2025	National Science Foundation Graduate Research Fellowship Program Honorable Mention
2024	Entomology & Insect Science Graduate Interdisciplinary Program First Year Fellowship

2022	Delta Alpha Pi Gamma Rho Honor Society Inductee
2020, 2021	Office of Multi-Ethnic Student Education Award of Academic Excellence
2019	National Hispanic Scholar

Media

[The Daily Wildcat](#) (March 30, 2026): Beyond the waiting room: CAPS is not just therapy

[Urban Radio Argentina](#) (May 26, 2022): Interview regarding Public Health in the United States

Argentine Public TV (November 5, 2020): Interview regarding the United States Election

[Time Magazine Cover](#) (June 3, 2019): Interview regarding Guns in America– A TIME and JR Project